

Singapore Travel Guide

Quick Facts

- **Country:** Republic of Singapore (city-state)
- **Languages:** English, Mandarin Chinese, Malay, Tamil (4 official languages, English widely spoken)
- **Currency:** Singapore Dollar (SGD, S\$)
- **Time Zone:** Singapore Standard Time (SST, UTC+8)
- **Emergency Number:** 999 (police, ambulance, fire)
- **Dialing Code:** +65
- **Nickname:** Lion City, Garden City

Visa Requirements

Singapore has generous visa-free policies for most countries.

Visa-Free Entry (Selected Countries)

30 Days Visa-Free

- **India, China, Russia, Ukraine:** 30 days
- **Note:** Most common for countries not in 90-day category

90 Days Visa-Free

- **United States:** 90 days
- **European Union:** 90 days (all member states)
- **United Kingdom:** 90 days
- **Canada:** 90 days
- **Australia, New Zealand:** 90 days
- **Japan, South Korea:** 90 days
- **Malaysia:** 30 days (special arrangement)

Entry Requirements

- Valid passport (must be valid for at least 6 months beyond stay)
- Return or onward ticket
- Proof of sufficient funds (at least SGD 100-150 per day)
- Immigration arrival card (e-arrival card online or on plane)
- Yellow fever vaccination certificate (if arriving from affected countries)

Important Notes

- Singapore immigration is strict - accurate information essential
- Working on tourist visa strictly prohibited (heavy fines, deportation, ban)
- Overstaying penalties severe (fines, jail time, future entry ban)
- Drug trafficking carries death penalty (declared on arrival card)
- Extensions possible at Immigration & Checkpoints Authority (ICA)

Visa on Arrival

Not available - must have visa-free status or obtain visa before arrival.

Best Time to Visit

Singapore has a tropical climate with fairly consistent weather year-round.

Year-Round Tropical Climate

- **Temperature:** 27-33°C (81-91°F) throughout year
- **Humidity:** 70-80% (high humidity daily)
- **Rain:** Possible any time, but patterns exist

Slightly Cooler & Wetter (November - January)

- **Weather:** 26-31°C (79-88°F), monsoon season, frequent afternoon thunderstorms
- **Rainfall:** Highest of year (wettest months)
- **Crowds:** Moderate, increases during Christmas/New Year
- **Events:** Christmas on Orchard Road, New Year celebrations
- **Pros:** Lush greenery, fewer tourists early November, festive atmosphere December
- **Cons:** Frequent rain, higher humidity, occasional flooding

Warmer & Drier (February - April)

- **Weather:** 28-33°C (82-91°F), less rain, more sunshine
- **Rainfall:** Lower, but still occasional showers
- **Crowds:** Moderate to high (Chinese New Year, school holidays)
- **Events:** Chinese New Year (January/February), Singapore International Festival of Arts (March)
- **Pros:** Less rain, comfortable for outdoor activities, festivals
- **Cons:** Still hot and humid, Chinese New Year crowds and price increases

Hot & Humid (May - October)

- **Weather:** 28-33°C (82-91°F), hot and humid
- **Rainfall:** Moderate, occasional afternoon showers
- **Haze:** Possible June-October (from Indonesian forest fires, varies by year)
- **Events:** Vesak Day (May), Great Singapore Sale (June-July), National Day (August 9), Mid-Autumn Festival (September)
- **Pros:** Fewer rain days than monsoon season, shopping sales, festivals
- **Cons:** Haze can affect air quality, very hot and humid, school holidays in June/December

Best Time to Visit: February-April (drier, post-monsoon) or July-August (festivals, shopping, school holiday energy).

Important: Singapore is a year-round destination - weather differences are subtle. Visit based on events and festivals rather than weather.

Avoid Haze: Check haze forecasts June-October (PSI air quality index), can affect outdoor activities.

Top Attractions

Attraction	District	Entry Fee	Hours	Best Time to Visit
Marina Bay Sands SkyPark	Marina Bay	SGD 32	10:00-22:00	Sunset or evening (city lights)
Gardens by the Bay	Marina Bay	SGD 53 (conservatories)	9:00-21:00	Evening (light show 19:45, 20:45)
Sentosa Island	Sentosa	Free (attractions vary)	Various	Full day, weekdays less crowded
Orchard Road	Orchard	Free (shopping varies)	10:00-22:00	Afternoon/evening, Christmas season
Singapore Zoo	Mandai	SGD 42	8:30-18:00	Morning (animals more active)
Night Safari	Mandai	SGD 55	19:15-midnight	After sunset, weekdays less crowded
Chinatown	Chinatown	Free (temples/shops vary)	Various	Morning for temples, evening for food
Little India	Little India	Free (temples/shops vary)	Various	Weekday morning or evening (less crowded)
Singapore Botanic Gardens	Tanglin	Free (orchid garden SGD 5)	5:00-midnight	Early morning or late afternoon
Jewel Changi Airport	Changi (airport)	Free (attractions vary)	24/7 (HSBC Rain Vortex)	Evening (light show), any time between flights

Additional Must-See Attractions

- **Merlion Park:** Iconic Singapore symbol, Marina Bay views (free, 24/7)
- **ArtScience Museum:** Lotus-shaped museum at Marina Bay Sands (SGD 19)
- **Haw Par Villa:** Quirky Chinese mythology theme park (free, 9:00-19:00)
- **Singapore Flyer:** Giant observation wheel (SGD 35, 8:30-22:30)
- **MacRitchie Reservoir:** Nature trails, treetop walk (free, great hiking)
- **Kampong Glam:** Historic Malay quarter, Sultan Mosque, Haji Lane (free)

Hawker Centers (Essential Singapore Experience)

- **Lau Pa Sat:** Historic Victorian market, satay street at night
- **Maxwell Food Centre:** Famous for Tian Tian chicken rice
- **Newton Food Centre:** Tourist-friendly, seafood (watch for overpricing)
- **Tiong Bahru Market:** Local favorite, less touristy
- **Old Airport Road Food Centre:** Locals' hawker center, authentic

Districts & Neighborhoods

Marina Bay

- **Character:** Futuristic waterfront, modern architecture, business district
- **Must-See:** Marina Bay Sands, Gardens by the Bay, Merlion Park, ArtScience Museum
- **Food:** High-end restaurants, hotel dining, food court in Marina Bay Sands
- **Transport:** Bayfront MRT (CE1, DT16)
- **Best For:** Instagram photos, luxury experiences, iconic Singapore landmarks

Orchard Road

- **Character:** Shopping paradise, luxury malls, tourist hub
- **Must-See:** ION Orchard, Takashimaya, Paragon, Ngee Ann City malls
- **Food:** Mall food courts, international restaurants, high-end dining
- **Transport:** Orchard MRT (NS22)
- **Best For:** Shopping, air-conditioned mall hopping, luxury brands, Christmas lights (December)

Chinatown

- **Character:** Historic Chinese quarter, temples, traditional shophouses
- **Must-See:** Buddha Tooth Relic Temple, Sri Mariamman Temple, Chinatown Heritage Centre, street markets
- **Food:** Hawker centers (Maxwell, Chinatown Complex), dim sum, traditional Chinese
- **Transport:** Chinatown MRT (NE4, DT19)
- **Best For:** Cultural immersion, budget shopping, authentic Chinese food, temples

Little India

- **Character:** Vibrant Indian culture, colorful streets, aromatic spice shops

- **Must-See:** Sri Veeramakaliamman Temple, Tekka Centre (wet market + hawker), Mustafa Centre (24-hour shopping)
- **Food:** Authentic Indian cuisine, banana leaf rice, roti prata, biryani
- **Transport:** Little India MRT (NE7)
- **Best For:** Cultural diversity, Indian food, vibrant atmosphere, budget shopping

Kampong Glam (Arab Quarter)

- **Character:** Malay-Muslim heritage, hipster cafes, boutique shops
- **Must-See:** Sultan Mosque, Haji Lane (colorful street, boutiques, cafes), Malay Heritage Centre
- **Food:** Middle Eastern, Mediterranean, halal options, trendy cafes
- **Transport:** Bugis MRT (EW12, DT14)
- **Best For:** Islamic architecture, boutique shopping, street art, multicultural food

Sentosa Island

- **Character:** Resort island, theme parks, beaches, attractions
- **Must-See:** Universal Studios Singapore, S.E.A. Aquarium, beaches (Siloso, Palawan, Tanjong), cable car
- **Food:** Beach clubs, resort restaurants, casual dining
- **Transport:** Sentosa Express from HarbourFront MRT, cable car, or walk via Sentosa Boardwalk
- **Best For:** Family entertainment, theme parks, beach relaxation, luxury resorts

Tiong Bahru

- **Character:** Trendy residential, art deco architecture, hipster cafes
- **Must-See:** Tiong Bahru Market, independent bookstores, street art, vintage shops
- **Food:** Hawker center (famous for breakfast), artisan bakeries, specialty coffee
- **Transport:** Tiong Bahru MRT (EW17)
- **Best For:** Local vibe, breakfast, coffee culture, architecture

Food & Dining

Hawker Culture (UNESCO Heritage - Essential Singapore Experience!)

What are Hawker Centers?

- Open-air food courts with dozens of independent stalls
- Each stall specializes in 1-3 dishes (decades of perfection)
- Authentic, cheap, delicious - THE way Singaporeans eat
- UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage (2020)

How to Eat at Hawker Centers

1. **Find a table:** Place tissue packet ("chope") to reserve
2. **Order from stalls:** Pay immediately, give table number if needed
3. **Stalls bring food:** Or pick up when ready
4. **Return trays:** To designated areas (new requirement, fines for not returning)
5. **Tipping:** Not expected or required

Prices

- **Breakfast:** SGD 3-5
- **Lunch/Dinner:** SGD 4-8 per dish
- **Drinks:** SGD 1-2

Must-Try Singaporean Dishes

Chicken Rice (Hainanese)

- **Description:** Poached/roasted chicken, fragrant rice cooked in chicken stock, chili sauce, ginger paste
- **Price:** SGD 4-6
- **Famous:** Tian Tian Chicken Rice (Maxwell), Boon Tong Kee
- **Verdict:** National dish, deceptively simple, perfectly executed

Laksa

- **Description:** Spicy coconut curry noodle soup with prawns, fish cake, tofu puffs
- **Price:** SGD 5-7

- **Famous:** 328 Katong Laksa, Sungei Road Laksa
- **Verdict:** Rich, spicy, creamy - addictive

Char Kway Teow

- **Description:** Stir-fried flat rice noodles with egg, Chinese sausage, prawns, cockles, bean sprouts
- **Price:** SGD 4-6
- **Famous:** Hill Street Fried Kway Teow
- **Verdict:** Smoky wok hei (breath of wok) essential

Satay

- **Description:** Grilled meat skewers (chicken, beef, mutton) with peanut sauce, cucumber, rice cakes
- **Price:** SGD 0.80-1.20 per stick (minimum 10)
- **Famous:** Lau Pa Sat Satay Street (evening), East Coast Lagoon Food Village
- **Verdict:** Smoky, sweet, savory - perfect beer snack

Chili Crab

- **Description:** Mud crab in sweet, savory, spicy tomato-chili sauce, eat with fried mantou (buns)
- **Price:** SGD 60-120 per crab (market price)
- **Famous:** No Signboard Seafood, Jumbo Seafood, Long Beach Seafood
- **Verdict:** Singapore's most famous dish, messy and delicious

Hokkien Mee

- **Description:** Stir-fried yellow noodles and rice noodles in prawn/squid broth, with lime and sambal
- **Price:** SGD 5-7
- **Famous:** Tian Tian Lai Hokkien Mee (Old Airport Road), Geylang Lor 29 Hokkien Mee
- **Verdict:** Umami bomb, addictive

Roti Prata

- **Description:** Flaky Indian flatbread, served with curry sauce (plain, egg, cheese, banana variations)
- **Price:** SGD 1.50-3

- **Famous:** Mr and Mrs Mohgan's Super Crispy Roti Prata, The Roti Prata House
- **Verdict:** Perfect breakfast or late-night snack

Bak Kut Teh

- **Description:** Pork rib soup in herbal broth, served with rice, youtiao (fried dough)
- **Price:** SGD 6-10
- **Famous:** Song Fa Bak Kut Teh, Ng Ah Sio
- **Verdict:** Comforting, herbal, peppery

International Cuisine

Singapore's multicultural food scene includes: - **Peranakan:** Fusion of Chinese and Malay (nyonya cuisine) - **Malay:** Nasi lemak, rendang, mee siam - **Indian:** Northern (tandoori, naan) and Southern (dosa, idli) - **Chinese:** All regional cuisines (Cantonese, Teochew, Hokkien, etc.) - **Western:** From cheap Western food stalls to Michelin fine dining

Tipping and Service

- **Hawker Centers:** No tipping
- **Restaurants:** 10% service charge usually included in bill ("+++" means subject to service charge and GST)
- **Extra Tip:** Not expected, but small amount for exceptional service appreciated
- **Delivery:** Round up or SGD 1-2 optional

Price Ranges

- **Budget (SGD 5-10/meal):** Hawker centers, food courts, local kopitiam (coffee shops)
- **Mid-Range (SGD 15-30/meal):** Casual restaurants, chain restaurants, cafe brunch
- **High-End (SGD 60-150+/meal):** Fine dining, hotel restaurants, seafood restaurants

Transportation

From Changi Airport

Changi Airport is consistently rated world's best airport, located 20 km east of city center.

MRT (Mass Rapid Transit) - Best Value

- **Route:** East-West Line (green) from Changi Airport to city (Bugis, City Hall, Raffles Place)

- **Cost:** SGD 2.50-3.00 depending on destination
- **Duration:** 30-45 minutes to city center
- **Hours:** 5:30am-midnight (last train ~11:30pm)
- **Pros:** Cheap, reliable, air-conditioned
- **Cons:** Not 24/7, need to transfer for some destinations

Taxi - Convenient

- **Cost:** SGD 20-40 to city center (metered + airport surcharge)
- **Surcharges:**
 - Airport: SGD 3-5 depending on time
 - Peak hours (6-9:30am, 6-midnight Mon-Fri): +25%
 - Midnight-6am: +50%
 - Electronic Road Pricing (ERP) tolls during peak hours
- **Duration:** 20-30 minutes (traffic dependent)
- **Where:** Taxi stands at each terminal

Grab (Rideshare) - Popular

- **Cost:** SGD 20-35 to city center (depends on time and surge)
- **Booking:** Via Grab app (download before arrival or use airport WiFi)
- **Pickup:** Designated Grab pickup points at each terminal
- **Pros:** Fixed price upfront, cashless, English communication in app
- **Cons:** Surge pricing during peak times

Airport Shuttle - Budget Group Option

- **Cost:** SGD 9-10 per person (shared shuttle to hotels)
- **Duration:** 45-60 minutes (multiple stops)
- **Booking:** At airport shuttle counters or online

Private Transfer - Luxury

- **Cost:** SGD 55-80 (pre-booked)
- **Pros:** Meet and greet, door-to-door, luggage assistance
- **Where:** Book online before arrival

MRT (Mass Rapid Transit)

System Overview

- **Lines:** 6 color-coded lines covering most of Singapore
- **Stations:** 140+ stations, expanding continuously
- **Hours:** ~5:30am-midnight (check specific line schedules)
- **Frequency:** Every 2-5 minutes peak hours, 5-8 minutes off-peak
- **Cleanliness:** Immaculate (no eating/drinking, hefty fines)

Fares and Payment

EZ-Link Card (Recommended)

- **Type:** Reloadable stored-value card
- **Cost:** SGD 10 (SGD 5 stored value + SGD 5 non-refundable card cost)
- **Top-Up:** At MRT station machines or 7-Eleven stores (SGD 10-50 increments)
- **Usage:** Tap in/out at gantries, cheaper than single tickets
- **Bonus:** Works on buses, even some taxis and shops

Singapore Tourist Pass

- **Type:** Unlimited travel pass
- **Cost:**
 - 1-day: SGD 22
 - 2-day: SGD 29
 - 3-day: SGD 34
- **Refund:** SGD 10 deposit refunded when returned within 5 days
- **Worth It?:** Break-even at 6-8 trips per day (most tourists don't take that many)
- **Where:** Changi Airport, selected MRT stations

Single Journey Tickets

- **Cost:** SGD 1.50-3.00 per trip
- **How:** Buy at station machines (not rechargeable, deposit returned after 6 trips)
- **Note:** More expensive than EZ-Link, time-consuming to buy each time

Navigation Tips

- **Color-Coded:** Follow line colors (Red, Green, Purple, Yellow, Blue, Brown)
- **Direction:** Check end station in desired direction
- **Transfers:** Free within 45 minutes, follow signs
- **Apps:** Google Maps excellent, MyTransport.SG (official app)

Buses

- **Coverage:** Extensive, reaches areas MRT doesn't
- **Fare:** SGD 1.00-2.50, tap EZ-Link card or pay cash (exact change)
- **Frequency:** 5-15 minutes most routes
- **Apps:** Google Maps, MyTransport.SG (shows real-time bus arrival)
- **Note:** Can be slower than MRT due to traffic

Taxis

- **Availability:** Abundant, metered
- **Base Fare:** SGD 3.90-5.00 (depending on taxi type)
- **Per KM:** SGD 0.60-0.90 (flagged down vs booked)
- **Surcharges:** Peak hours, midnight, CBD, airport (add 25-50% to fare)
- **Apps:** Comfort/CityCab app, GrabTaxi
- **Tip:** Pre-book for airport/early morning

Grab (Singapore's Uber)

- **Availability:** Excellent coverage, English app
- **Types:** GrabCar (regular), GrabShare (carpool cheaper), GrabTaxi (metered taxi via app)
- **Payment:** Credit card or PayNow (local), cash option available
- **Pricing:** Transparent upfront pricing, surge during peak times
- **Note:** Uber exited Singapore, Grab is dominant rideshare

Walking

- **Climate:** Hot and humid, walk short distances only
- **Covered Walkways:** Extensive network in CBD, Orchard Road
- **Safety:** Very safe, pedestrian-friendly, clean sidewalks
- **Crossing:** Use designated crossings, jay-walking fines (though rarely enforced for tourists)

Cycling

- **Network:** Growing bike lane network, park connectors
- **Bike Share:** SG Bike, Anywheel (app-based, SGD 1-2 per trip)
- **Note:** Not as popular as MRT due to heat/humidity, but nice in parks

Cultural Tips & Customs

Multiracial, Multireligious, Multicultural

- **Diversity:** Chinese (75%), Malay (15%), Indian (7.5%), Others (2.5%)
- **Religions:** Buddhism, Islam, Christianity, Hinduism, Taoism
- **Languages:** English is working language, most people bilingual
- **Respect:** Be mindful of religious/cultural sensitivities

Language - Singlish

- **Official Language:** English (business, government, education)
- **Singlish:** Colloquial English mixed with Chinese, Malay, Tamil influences
- **Examples:**
 - "Can lah" = Yes, ok
 - "Lah, lor, leh" = Sentence-ending particles for emphasis
 - "Chope" = Reserve (table with tissue packet)
 - "Shiok" = Delicious, awesome
- **Understanding:** Locals will speak standard English with tourists if you don't understand

Strict Laws (Take Seriously!)

- **Chewing Gum:** Import/sale banned (personal use for dental health ok, but no selling)
- **Littering:** SGD 300-1,000 fine
- **Smoking:** Only in designated areas, SGD 200-1,000 fine (airports, hawkers, most public areas non-smoking)
- **Jaywalking:** SGD 20-1,000 fine (rarely enforced, but possible)
- **Drugs:** Zero tolerance, death penalty for trafficking, mandatory jail for possession
- **Vandalism:** Caning punishment (famously strict)
- **Not Returning Trays:** SGD 10 fine at hawker centers (new requirement)

Social Etiquette

- **Punctuality:** Be on time, efficiency valued
- **Queuing:** Form orderly lines, no cutting
- **Quiet Public Behavior:** Don't be loud on MRT, public areas
- **Politeness:** "Please," "Thank you," "Excuse me" appreciated
- **Shoes:** Remove when entering homes, some shops (mosques, temples always)

Visiting Temples and Mosques

- **Dress Code:** Modest clothing (cover shoulders, knees)
- **Shoes:** Remove before entering
- **Photography:** Ask permission, especially during prayers
- **Donations:** Small donation appreciated but not required
- **Respect:** Observe quietly during prayer times

Tipping

- **General Rule:** Not required or expected
- **Restaurants:** 10% service charge usually included
- **Hotels:** Discretionary, SGD 2-5 for porters if you wish
- **Taxis:** Round up if you want, but not expected
- **Hawkers:** Never tip

"Kiasu" Culture

- **Meaning:** "Fear of losing out" - competitive, always want best deal
- **Examples:** Queuing early for sales, chope-ing tables, competitive parenting
- **Observation:** Part of Singaporean identity, often self-mocking

Safety & Health

General Safety

- **Crime:** Extremely low crime rate, one of safest cities globally
- **Walking:** Safe day and night in all areas
- **Scams:** Very rare, but standard tourist scams possible (overpriced taxis at tourist spots)

- **Lost Items:** High chance of recovery, police efficient

Laws and Enforcement

- **Strict:** Singapore has strict laws, enforcement is real
- **Fines:** Littering, smoking in wrong areas, jaywalking, not returning trays
- **Drugs:** Absolutely zero tolerance (death penalty for trafficking)
- **Respect Laws:** Not a police state, but rules are enforced

Health and Medical

- **Healthcare:** World-class, but expensive
- **Travel Insurance:** Essential (medical care not free)
- **Hospitals:** Singapore General Hospital, Raffles Hospital (private, English-speaking)
- **Pharmacies:** Guardian, Watsons (Western medications available)
- **Tap Water:** Safe to drink (high quality)

Food Safety

- **Standards:** Very high, food inspections rigorous
- **Hawker Centers:** Safe to eat (despite open-air, hygiene standards strict)
- **Grades:** A, B, C hygiene grades displayed (A is best)
- **Allergies:** Inform hawker stall, but cross-contamination possible

Heat and Humidity

- **Hydration:** Drink water constantly (available everywhere)
- **Sunscreen:** Essential even on cloudy days
- **Air Conditioning:** Everywhere (bring layer, indoor AC very cold)
- **Heat Exhaustion:** Take breaks in air-conditioned malls, hydrate

Emergency Services

- **Universal Emergency:** 999 (police, ambulance, fire)
- **Non-Emergency Police:** 1800-255-0000
- **Tourism Hotline:** 1800-736-2000 (English)

Practical Information

Electricity and Adapters

- **Voltage:** 230V
- **Frequency:** 50Hz
- **Plug Type:** Type G (UK-style three rectangular prongs)
- **Adapters:** US/EU visitors need adapters (buy at Mustafa Centre, 7-Eleven, or Changi Airport)

Internet and WiFi

- **Wireless@SG:** Free public WiFi at malls, MRT stations, public areas (register with phone number)
- **Hotels/Cafes:** Free WiFi almost everywhere
- **SIM Cards:** Tourist SIMs at Changi Airport (Singtel, StarHub, M1, SGD 12-30 for 7-30 days)
- **Coverage:** Excellent 4G/5G nationwide
- **Roaming:** Check your carrier for Singapore roaming packages

Money and Currency

- **Currency:** Singapore Dollar (SGD, S\$)
- **ATMs:** Abundant, accept international cards (minimal fees)
- **Credit Cards:** Widely accepted (Visa, Mastercard, Amex)
- **Cashless:** PayNow, GrabPay, PayLah! (local e-wallets), but cards work for tourists
- **Money Changers:** Better rates than banks (avoid airport, try People's Park, Lucky Plaza)
- **Cash:** Carry some for hawker centers (though many now accept cards/NETS)

GST (Goods and Services Tax)

- **Rate:** 9% (as of 2024, increased from 8%)
- **Included:** Prices usually include GST
- **Restaurants:** Look for "++" which means subject to 10% service charge + 9% GST
- **Tourist Refund:** Claim GST refund for purchases over SGD 100 at airport (eTRS system)

Business Hours

- **Shops/Malls:** 10:00-22:00 daily
- **Hawker Centers:** 7:00-20:00 or 21:00 (some stalls earlier/later, some 24/7)

- **Restaurants:** Varies, 11:30-14:30 lunch, 18:00-22:00 dinner (many all-day)
- **Banks:** Monday-Friday 9:30-16:30, Saturday mornings (some branches)
- **Museums:** Usually 10:00-18:00 or 19:00

Useful Apps

- **MyTransport.SG:** Official public transport app (bus/MRT arrival times)
- **Grab:** Rideshare/taxi/food delivery
- **FoodPanda/Deliveroo:** Food delivery
- **Google Maps:** Excellent navigation for Singapore
- **Burpple:** Food discovery and reviews (Singapore's version of Yelp)

Public Holidays

- **New Year:** January 1
- **Chinese New Year:** January/February (2 days, dates vary, biggest holiday)
- **Good Friday:** March/April (variable)
- **Hari Raya Puasa:** Variable (Islamic calendar)
- **Labour Day:** May 1
- **Vesak Day:** May (variable, Buddha's birthday)
- **Hari Raya Haji:** Variable (Islamic calendar)
- **National Day:** August 9 (Singapore's independence, big celebrations)
- **Deepavali:** October/November (variable, Hindu festival of lights)
- **Christmas:** December 25

Day Trips from Singapore

Johor Bahru, Malaysia

- **Distance:** 1 km across causeway (30 min-2 hours depending on immigration queues)
- **Highlights:** LEGOLAND Malaysia, shopping (cheaper than Singapore), food
- **Transport:** Public bus (SGD 1-2), private car, or tour
- **Visa:** Check if you need visa for Malaysia (different from Singapore)
- **Note:** Immigration can be slow (especially weekends), bring passport

Pulau Ubin

- **Distance:** 10 min boat ride from Changi Point
- **Highlights:** Rustic island, cycling, nature trails, old kampong (village) vibes
- **Transport:** Bumboat from Changi Point Ferry Terminal (SGD 4 per person)
- **Duration:** Half day or full day
- **Bring:** Water, sunscreen, rent bike on island (SGD 8-15)

Batam/Bintan Islands, Indonesia

- **Distance:** 1-2 hour ferry from Tanah Merah Ferry Terminal
- **Highlights:** Beach resorts, water sports, golf, spa, cheap shopping
- **Transport:** Ferry (SGD 30-60 return)
- **Visa:** Check Indonesia visa requirements (may be visa-free or visa on arrival)
- **Duration:** Weekend getaway or day trip

Kusu Island

- **Distance:** 30 min ferry from Marina South Pier
- **Highlights:** Beaches, tortoise sanctuary, temple, peaceful island
- **Transport:** Ferry (SGD 18 return, seasonal - check schedule)
- **Duration:** Half day
- **Season:** Best May-October

Budget Guide

Daily Budget Estimates

Budget Traveler (SGD 80-120/day): - Accommodation: Hostel dorm (SGD 25-40) - Meals: Hawker centers only (SGD 15-25) - Transport: MRT/buses only (SGD 10-15) - Activities: Free attractions, one paid museum (SGD 10-20)

Mid-Range Traveler (SGD 200-350/day): - Accommodation: 3-star hotel or boutique hostel (SGD 100-150) - Meals: Mix hawker + casual restaurants (SGD 40-60) - Transport: MRT + occasional Grab (SGD 15-25) - Activities: Paid attractions, museums, shows (SGD 40-80)

Luxury Traveler (SGD 500+/day): - Accommodation: 4-5 star hotel (SGD 250-600+) - Meals: Restaurant dining, fine dining (SGD 100-200+) - Transport: Grab/taxis (SGD 30-50) - Activities: Premium experiences, private tours (SGD 100-200+)

Money-Saving Tips

1. **Hawker Centers:** Eat like locals, SGD 5-8 meals instead of SGD 30+ restaurants
2. **Free Attractions:** Botanic Gardens, Merlion, Henderson Waves, walking trails, temples
3. **Happy Hours:** Many bars 5-8pm discounted drinks
4. **EZ-Link Card:** Cheaper than single tickets on MRT
5. **Avoid Tourist Traps:** Newton Circus hawker prices inflated, go to local hawker centers
6. **GST Refund:** Claim back tax on shopping at airport
7. **Water Fountains:** Bring refillable bottle (tap water safe)
8. **Walk When Possible:** Short distances between attractions in Marina Bay/Chinatown/etc.

Final Tips

1. **Embrace Hawker Culture:** It's THE Singapore experience - cheap, delicious, authentic
2. **Respect the Rules:** Fines are real, don't chew gum, litter, or smoke outside designated areas
3. **Stay Hydrated:** Humidity is intense, drink water constantly
4. **Use Air-Con Malls:** Cool off between outdoor activities
5. **Tissue Packet Chope:** Respect the chope culture (reserved tables)
6. **"Can or Not?":** Typical Singlish question, means "Is this possible?"
7. **Changi Airport:** Arrive early, explore Jewel, it's an attraction itself
8. **Mix Cultures:** Try all the different cuisines - Chinese, Malay, Indian, Peranakan
9. **Download Apps:** Grab, MyTransport.SG, Google Maps essential
10. **Efficiency:** Singapore is highly efficient - trains on time, services fast, embrace it

Emergency Contacts: - Emergency: 999 - Police Hotline: 1800-255-0000 - Tourism Hotline: 1800-736-2000

Singapore is a city where East meets West, tradition meets innovation, and hawker centers serve world-class food for SGD 5. Clean, safe, efficient, and incredibly diverse - it's Asia's most accessible entry point and a food lover's paradise.

Enjoy your Singapore adventure! Selamat datang! ! (Welcome in Malay, Chinese, Tamil!)